

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'Immeasurable Praise of Qualities'

Āryāparimitaguṇānuśaṃsā-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 679 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཡན་ཏན་བསམས་པ་དཔག་ཏུ་མཛད་པ་ཞེས་བརྟེན་གྱི་ཟུང་།

Toh 679 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Āryāparimita-guṇānuśaṃsā-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the Phags pa yon tan bsnags pa dpag tu med pa zhes bya ba'i gzungs, rendered into English as "The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Immeasurable Praise of Qualities." It belongs to the dhāraṇī class of Buddhist canonical literature, presenting a short but potent mantra dedicated to the buddha Amitābha, whose name and epithets are invoked in the opening homage. The text promises considerable soteriological benefits from its recitation, including the purification of vast accumulations of karmic obscuration and the acquisition of merit equivalent to that generated by thousands of buddhas. As a dhāraṇī associated with Amitābha, it connects to the broader Pure Land tradition while functioning as a practical liturgical and ritual formula within the Kangyur.

And it shall be transformed as well. The recollection of Amitābha is now complete.

In the language of India: Āryāparimita-guṇānuśamsā-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The noble dhāraṇī called "Immeasurable Praise of Qualities."

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namo bhagavate amitābhāya tathāgatāya arhate
samyaksaṃbuddhāya. Tadyathā: Oṃ amite amitod-bhave amita-saṃbhave
amita-vikrānte amita-gāmini gagana-kīrti-kari sarva-kleśa-ksayam-kari svāhā.

The method of practice for this dhāraṇī is as follows. Reciting it a single time purifies the karmic obscurations accumulated over one hundred thousand eons. Reciting it three times each day — morning, midday, and evening — purifies all negative deeds. One attains the wholesome roots generated by one thousand buddhas. Reciting it twenty-one times purifies the four transgressions. Reciting it one hundred thousand times, one will behold the noble Maitreya (Skt. Maitreya), the bodhisattva of loving-kindness. Reciting it two hundred thousand times, one will behold the noble Avalokiteśvara, the Lord Who Looks with Compassion. Reciting it...

Translator's Notes

- The opening line "And it shall be transformed as well" and "The recollection of Amitābha is now complete" are closing colophon lines belonging to a preceding section, likely a eulogy or sādhana of Amitābha, and mark a textual boundary before the new dhāraṇī text begins. The Sanskrit mantra transliteration is preserved from the Tibetan as received, which itself reflects a phonetic rendering of Sanskrit; the text ends mid-sentence with "□□□" indicating the passage is cut off.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.